

and he began to lament and to supplicate before the Lord because of his transgression. 24. And we told him in a dream that it was forgiven him because he supplicated earnestly, and lamented, and did not again commit it. 25. And he received forgiveness because he turned from his sin and from his ignorance, for he transgressed greatly before our God; and every one that acts thus, every one who lies with his mother-in-law, let them burn him with fire that he may burn therein, for there is uncleanness and pollution upon them; with fire let them burn them. 26. And do thou command the children of Israel that there be no uncleanness amongst them, for every one who lies with his daughter-in-law or with his mother-in-law hath wrought uncleanness; with fire let them burn the man who has lain with her, and likewise the woman, and He will turn away wrath and punishment from Israel. 27. And unto Judah we said that his two sons had not lain with her, and for this reason his seed was established for a second generation, and would not be rooted out. 28. For in singleness of eye he had gone and sought for punishment, namely, according to the judgment of Abraham, which he had commanded his sons, Judah had sought to burn her with fire.

24-25^a. Cf. Test. Jud. 19: *εἰ μὴ ἡ μετάνοια σαρκὸς μου, καὶ ἡ ταπεινώσις ψυχῆς μου, καὶ αἱ εὐχαὶ Ἰακώβ τοῦ πατρὸς μου, ἀτεκνος εἶχον ἀποθανεῖν. ἀλλ' ὁ θεὸς . . . ὁ οἰκτίρμων καὶ ἐλεήμων συνέγνω ὅτι ἐν ἀγνοίᾳ ἐποίησα.*

25. *Received forgiveness because he turned from his sin and from his ignorance.* Something seems wrong. We ought to have the idea expressed in Test. Jud. 19: *συνέγνω ὅτι ἐν ἀγνοίᾳ ἐποίησα.* Cf. 1 Tim. i. 13: *ἡλεήθην, ὅτι ἀγνοῶν ἐποίησα.* *δ* transposes "because he turned" after "ignorance." If we transpose the clauses "because . . . sin" and "from his ignorance," we should have an excellent sense: "received forgiveness because of his ignor-

ance and because he turned from his sin"; for the Eth. preposition *emna* means either "from" or "because of."

Every one who lies with his mother-in-law, let them burn him with fire. So Lev. xx. 14 enacts.

26. *Lies with his daughter-in-law.* Cf. Lev. xviii. 15, xx. 12. The punishment ordained for this offence is death in the passages referred to in Leviticus; but the form of death is not specified. On the other hand, death by fire is the penalty presupposed for this offence in Gen. xxxviii. 24. Our text (xx. 4) enjoins this penalty for adultery or fornication.

28. *According to the judgment of Abraham.* See note on xx. 4.